# THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679


## ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 8: **The Gupta Era** | Class 7 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

### SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

| Q. | Correct Option | Brief Reasoning |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **(b)** one-sided praise from a court poet | Bias |
| 2 | **(d)** Guptas relied more on feudatories and land grants | Decentralised |
| 3 | **(c)** to display cultural refinement | Image-making |
| 4 | **(a)** prosperity and social inequality existed together | Nuanced picture |
| 5 | **(b)** spread of agriculture and rise of temple economy | Economic change |
| 6 | **(a)** one is by a court poet, the other by an outsider | Source type |
| 7 | **(c)** wide trade contacts | Archaeology |
| 8 | **(a)** Aryabhatiya | Text |
| 9 | **(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A. | The protective layer is the reason the iron does not rust. |
| 10 | **(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A. | A court poet writing in praise explains why the record is full of praise. |

### SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 11 | Praise the king (1); Omit defeats (1). | 1+1 |
| 12 | Weak centre (1); Strong feudatories (1). | 1+1 |
| 13 | Village names (1); Taxes (1). | 1+1 |
| 14 | Outsider's view (1); Detail (1). | 1+1 |

### SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 15 | Achievements (1); Elite focus (1); Limits (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 16 | Hindu patronage (1); Buddhist centres (1); Tolerance (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 17 | Faxian (1); Texts (1); Inscriptions (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Faxian (1); Prashasti (1); Cross-check (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 18 | Prabhavati (1); Education (1); Limits (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Subjects (1); Students (1); Patronage (1). | 1+1+1 |

### SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 19 | (i) China (1). (ii) To visit Buddhist sites and collect texts (1). (iii) Chandragupta II (1). (iv) A traveller records only what he saw and may be biased or mistaken (1); comparing with inscriptions and coins confirms facts and gives a fuller picture (1). | 1+1+1+2 |
| 20 | Science (1); Literature (1); Art (1); Education (1); Significance (1). | 1+1+1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Vakatakas (1); Pallavas (1); Kamarupa (1); Alliances (1); Culture (1). | 1+1+1+1+1 |

**Mistakes to avoid:**

- Writing the Prayaga Prashasti as Kalidasa's work; it was composed by **Harisena** for **Samudragupta**.
- Saying the Iron Pillar of Delhi is made of stainless steel; it is iron that resists rust because of a thin **protective surface layer**.
- Confusing travellers: **Faxian** (Chinese, Chandragupta II's time) is not **Megasthenes** (Greek, Mauryan court).
- Mixing authors and books: **Aryabhata** - Aryabhatiya; **Varahamihira** - Brihat Samhita; **Kalidasa** - Meghaduta and Shakuntalam.
- Writing that the Guptas ruled from Delhi; their capital was **Pataliputra**.
- Naming the invaders who hastened the Gupta decline wrongly; they were the **Hunas** from Central Asia.

**Evaluator's note:** Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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## ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 8: **The Gupta Era** | Class 7 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

### SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

| Q. | Correct Option | Brief Reasoning |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **(d)** calm expression and fine drapery | Gupta style |
| 2 | **(a)** spread of court culture and Sanskrit | Cultural diffusion |
| 3 | **(d)** Kalidasa's association with the court | Patronage |
| 4 | **(a)** benefits were uneven across society | Critical view |
| 5 | **(d)** Aryabhata and Varahamihira | Astronomy |
| 6 | **(d)** advanced metallurgical skills | Technology |
| 7 | **(d)** regional powers existed alongside the Guptas | Diversity |
| 8 | **(c)** mobile cavalry and weak Gupta frontier | Military factors |
| 9 | **(b)** Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A. | Both are true, but his purpose does not explain when he came. |
| 10 | **(c)** A is true but R is false. | A is true; R is false, it is a poem in which a yaksha sends a message through a cloud. |

### SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 11 | Royal grants (1); Reputation (1). | 1+1 |
| 12 | Faced Hunas (1); Last strong king (1). | 1+1 |
| 13 | Trade (1); Show wealth (1). | 1+1 |
| 14 | Place value (1); Calculations (1). | 1+1 |

### SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 15 | Rewards (1); Decentralisation (1); Temple economy (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 16 | Ajanta (1); Sarnath (1); Temples (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 17 | Vakatakas (1); Licchavis (1); Security (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Cavalry (1); Loss of revenue (1); Collapse (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 18 | Agriculture (1); Crafts (1); Trade (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Elite sources (1); Ignoring the poor (1); Balanced view (1). | 1+1+1 |

### SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 19 | (i) The Aryabhatiya (1). (ii) Day and night (1). (iii) Sushruta (1). (iv) Scholars made important advances in mathematics, astronomy and medicine (1); the peace and royal patronage of the period supported learning (1). | 1+1+1+2 |
| 20 | Agriculture (1); Trade (1); Guilds (1); Coinage (1); Inequality (1). | 1+1+1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Sarnath (1); Deogarh (1); Ajanta (1); Themes (1); Patrons (1). | 1+1+1+1+1 |

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- Mixing authors and books: **Aryabhata** - Aryabhatiya; **Varahamihira** - Brihat Samhita; **Kalidasa** - Meghaduta and Shakuntalam.
- Writing that the Guptas ruled from Delhi; their capital was **Pataliputra**.
- Naming the invaders who hastened the Gupta decline wrongly; they were the **Hunas** from Central Asia.

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## ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 8: **The Gupta Era** | Class 7 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

### SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

| Q. | Correct Option | Brief Reasoning |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **(a)** importance of Buddhist patronage and art skills | Heritage |
| 2 | **(d)** repeated invasions and loss of revenue | Decline |
| 3 | **(a)** writing numbers with zero | Heritage |
| 4 | **(d)** trade and travellers carried them | Transmission |
| 5 | **(b)** art set standards of balance and grace | Style |
| 6 | **(a)** use of the Sanskrit classics in schools | Legacy |
| 7 | **(b)** evidence mostly from elite sources | Historiography |
| 8 | **(b)** state patronage and renowned scholars | Institutional support |
| 9 | **(d)** A is false but R is true. | A is false, he wrote the Aryabhatiya; R is true. |
| 10 | **(b)** Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A. | Both are true, but one site's fame does not explain the other's. |

### SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 11 | Patronage (1); Tolerance (1). | 1+1 |
| 12 | Titles (1); Patronage (1). | 1+1 |
| 13 | Caves protect (1); Skilled painters (1). | 1+1 |
| 14 | Image of king (1); Titles (1). | 1+1 |

### SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 15 | Zero (1); Astronomy (1); Medicine (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 16 | Wealth (1); Image (1); Trade (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 17 | Numerals (1); Literature (1); Architecture (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Centralisation (1); Feudatories (1); Revenue (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 18 | Trade (1); Sanskrit (1); Temples (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Local resources (1); Trade (1); Patronage (1). | 1+1+1 |

### SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 19 | (i) Chandragupta II (1). (ii) The Vakataka dynasty (1). (iii) One who rules on behalf of a child ruler (1). (iv) Royal women could hold real power and take decisions (1); marriage alliances were a way of building political ties (1). | 1+1+1+2 |
| 20 | Territory (1); Administration (1); Religion (1); Economy (1); Legacy (1). | 1+1+1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Observations (1); Society (1); Government (1); Bias (1); Comparison (1). | 1+1+1+1+1 |

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